

To the Members of the School Board,

I am writing anonymously because I fear retaliation and potential consequences to my employment if my identity becomes known. The fact that I do not feel comfortable attaching my name to these concerns should itself be considered a sign of the culture many employees are experiencing.

For clarity, when I refer to administration in this letter, I am referring primarily to the Director. With the inclusion of experiences with the Director of Finance/IT as well as the Vice Principal of Kindergarten through 5th grade.

I have observed and experienced a pattern of intimidation, inconsistent expectations, and a lack of psychological safety within the workplace. Employees are encouraged to collaborate, share ideas, and take initiative. However, there have been instances where employees have later been criticized, reprimanded, or placed in difficult situations for doing exactly that, particularly when ideas or solutions did not originate from leadership.

This creates an environment where employees become reluctant to contribute, collaborate, or offer suggestions. Rather than feeling empowered to help increase student success, many feel the need to remain silent to avoid negative consequences.

In addition to my own observations, four teachers have personally told me they are actively seeking other employment due to their experiences with the current Director and leadership environment. They have said they do not feel safe expressing concerns to administration because they fear retaliation or negative consequences.

I have also been told by two other teachers that they are uncomfortable meeting alone with the Director. Additionally, there is a growing perception among staff that failure to comply with administrative expectations, even when those expectations may be unclear or inconsistently applied, can result in negative consequences.

This atmosphere of fear has contributed to the loss of talented and dedicated educators, whether through resignation or termination. While these issues have a significant impact on faculty morale, I believe the greatest impact is on our students. When experienced and highly effective teachers leave or are removed, students lose trusted mentors, instructional continuity is disrupted, and overall student success suffers.

A healthy workplace requires trust, open communication, and confidence that concerns can be raised without fear.

My intention is not to attack any individual. Rather, I hope the Board will take seriously the concerns of employees who may feel unable to speak openly. I respectfully ask that the Board seek confidential feedback from current and recent faculty who have served under the current director. This could evaluate whether employees feel safe expressing concerns, offering ideas,

collaborating with colleagues, and carrying out their work without fear of retaliation or intimidation.

If the Board chooses to gather feedback from current and recent faculty, I strongly encourage the use of a truly anonymous third-party survey administered by an independent organization. I do not believe many employees would feel comfortable providing candid feedback if there were any possibility that responses could be traced back to them. A third-party process would provide the best opportunity for teachers to speak honestly about their experiences.

I would also encourage the Board to ask direct questions regarding faculty trust in administration, including whether employees feel respected, supported, heard, and safe raising concerns. In my view, the central issue is not simply employee satisfaction, but whether there is a genuine level of trust between faculty and administration.

Thank you for your consideration and for your commitment to ensuring a healthy, professional, and supportive work environment for all employees and, ultimately, for the students they serve.

Sincerely,

A Concerned Employee